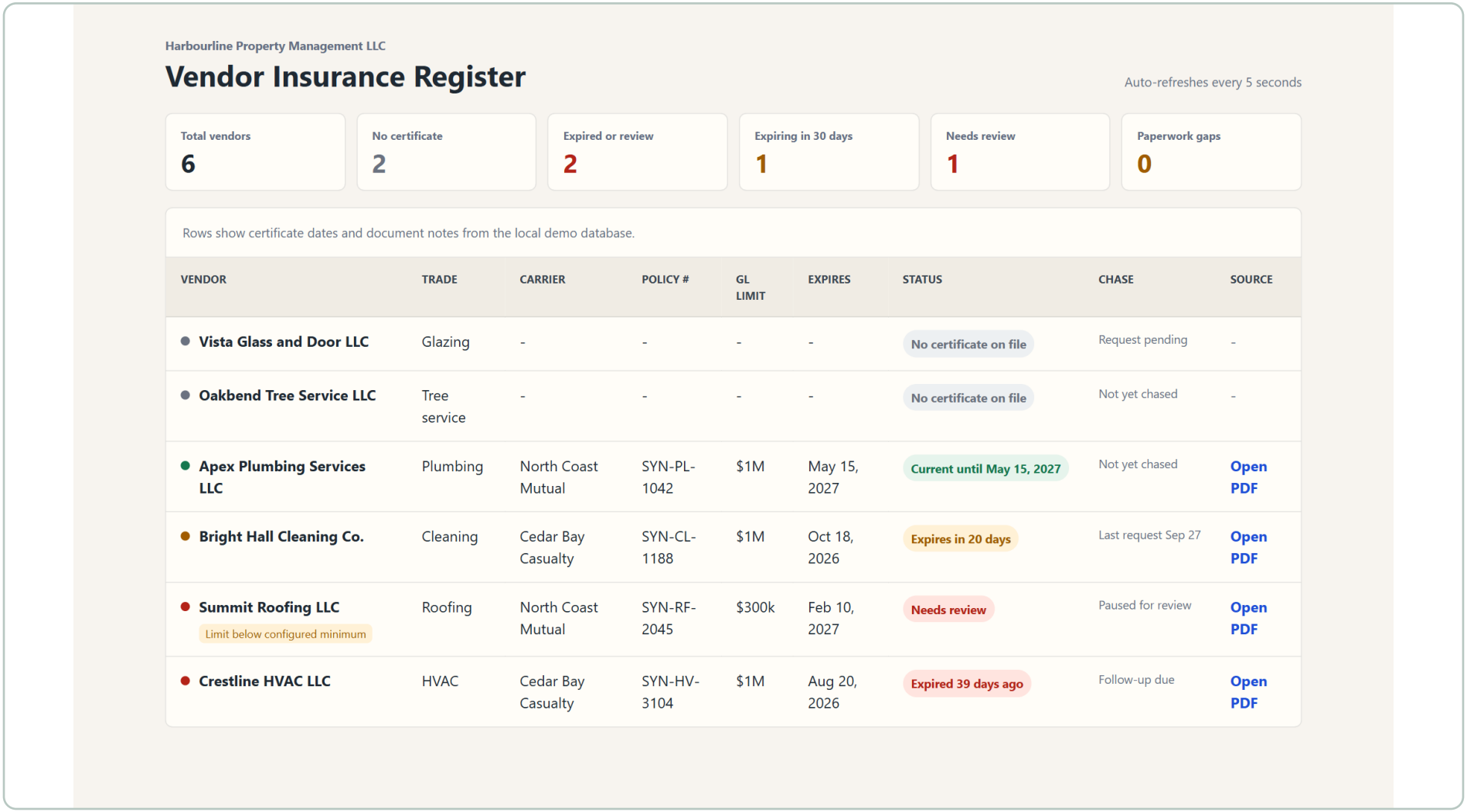
AUTOMATION CASE STUDY

Vendor COI chasing

Six n8n workflows connect certificate intake, validation, a vendor register, renewal chasing and human approval.



Harbourline Property Management LLC

Vendor Insurance Register

Auto-refreshes every 5 seconds

Total vendors	No certificate	Expired or review	Expiring in 30 days	Needs review	Paperwork gaps
6	2	2	1	1	0

Rows show certificate dates and document notes from the local demo database.

VENDOR	TRADE	CARRIER	POLICY #	GL LIMIT	EXPIRES	STATUS	CHASE	SOURCE
Vista Glass and Door LLC	Glazing	-	-	-	-	No certificate on file	Request pending	-
Oakbend Tree Service LLC	Tree service	-	-	-	-	No certificate on file	Not yet chased	-
Apex Plumbing Services LLC	Plumbing	North Coast Mutual	SYN-PL-1042	$1M	May 15, 2027	Current until May 15, 2027	Not yet chased	Open PDF
Bright Hall Cleaning Co.	Cleaning	Cedar Bay Casualty	SYN-CL-1188	$1M	Oct 18, 2026	Expires in 20 days	Last request Sep 27	Open PDF
Summit Roofing LLC Limit below configured minimum	Roofing	North Coast Mutual	SYN-RF-2045	$300k	Feb 10, 2027	Needs review	Paused for review	Open PDF
Crestline HVAC LLC	HVAC	Cedar Bay Casualty	SYN-HV-3104	$1M	Aug 20, 2026	Expired 39 days ago	Follow-up due	Open PDF

REGISTER OUTPUT / rendered by the project dashboard workflow

Illustrative synthetic rows

SYSTEM DESIGN

One connected automation

n8n handles orchestration. Postgres stores vendors, certificates, coverage, notices and outreach state. Original PDFs stay linked to the register.

01 **COI Intake**

Gmail, upload form or fixture -> PDF storage, extraction and validation

02 **Source Document Route**

Serves the stored original PDF behind a certificate link

03 **Daily Watch and Chase**

Selects due vendors, drafts requests and records pending outreach

04 **Vendor Approval Request**

One execution per vendor; sends only after a human approves

05 **Non-PDF Reply Notice**

Captures replies that require manual attention rather than PDF processing

06 **COI Dashboard**

Reads Postgres and renders a vendor status register

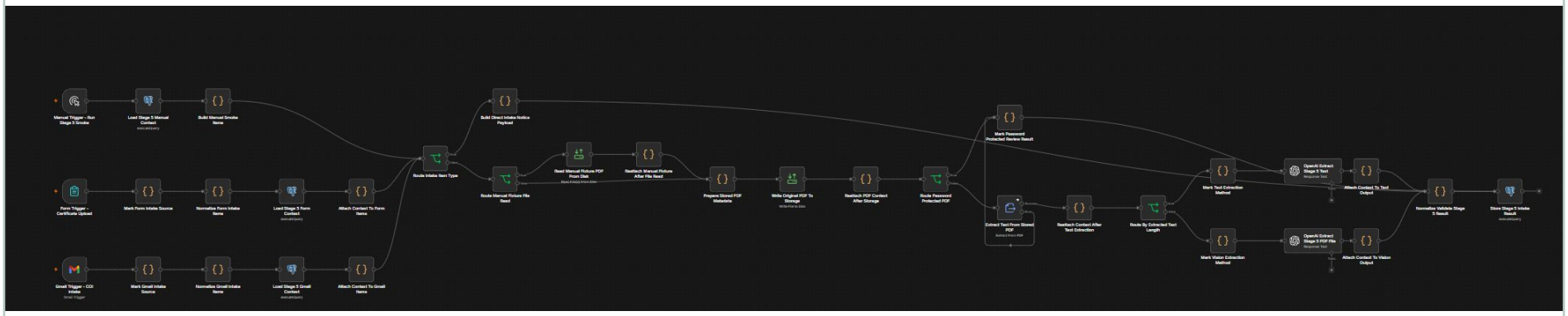
How the pieces connect

The intake workflow writes certificate records to Postgres. The daily watch reads that state, routes each prepared message through human approval, and the dashboard presents the resulting register.

WORKFLOW 01 / COI INTAKE

Three entry paths, one intake pipeline

Direct n8n editor capture. All 35 functional nodes are visible in this overview; the next two pages enlarge the stages for reading.



What it does

- Accepts a Gmail PDF attachment, browser upload, or controlled manual fixture run.
- Normalizes the source, stores the original PDF, and keeps a source reference.
- Extracts certificate facts, runs deterministic checks, then persists the result in Postgres.

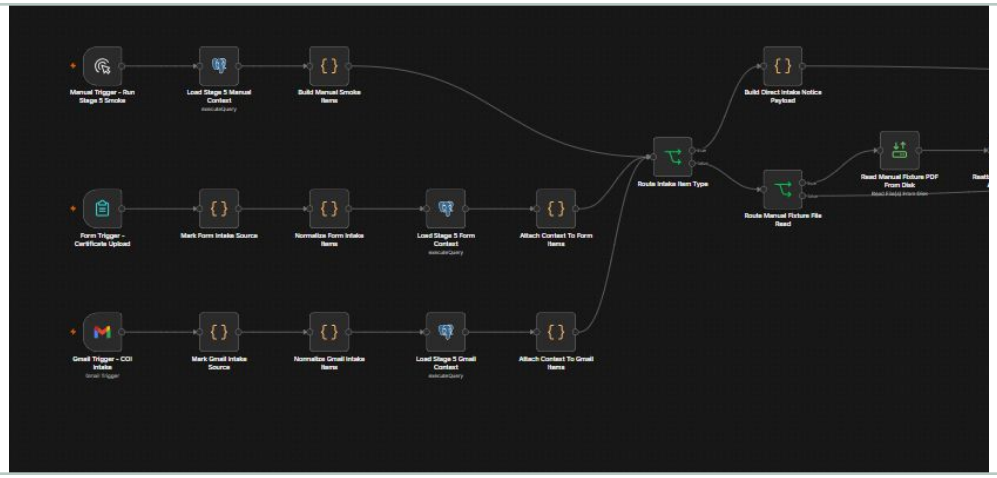
Why the flow is split

The same validation path follows each source. This keeps upload and email behavior aligned and makes fixture checks repeatable.

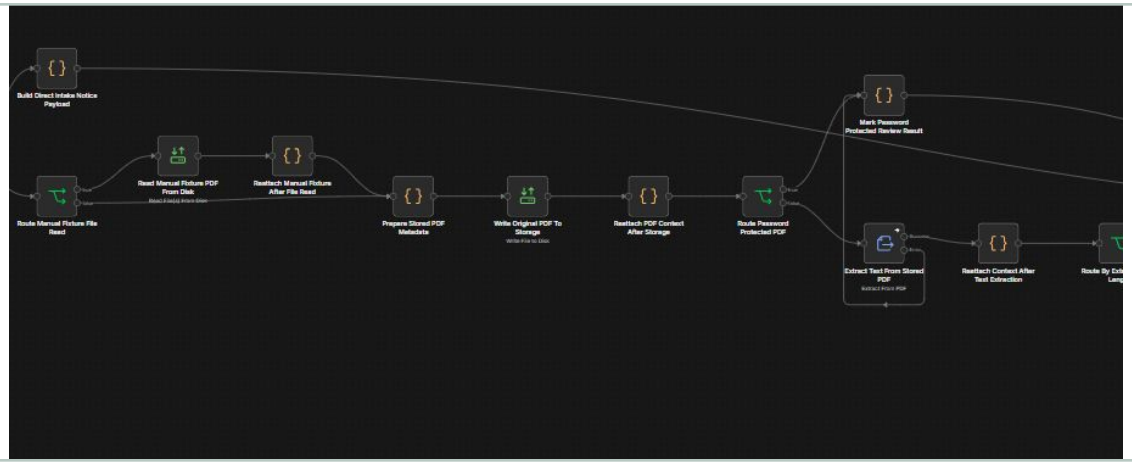
Sources and original-file handling

Enlarged views of the same canvas. These are direct n8n screenshots, cropped for legibility.

A / SOURCE BRANCHES



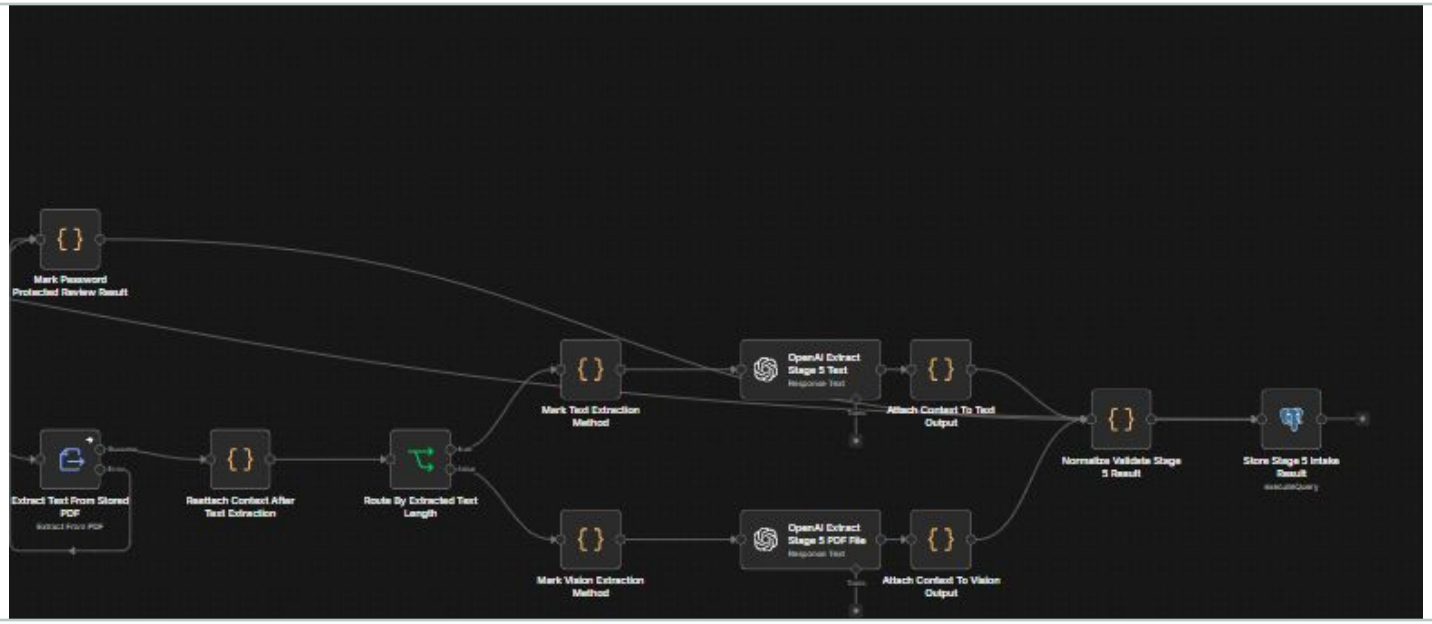
B / PDF STORAGE AND EXTRACTION BRANCH



The original is saved before parsing; a low-text PDF can take the visual extraction path.

Structured facts, fixed rules

The model transcribes document facts into a schema. Project code then applies repeatable flags and storage decisions.



Examples of checks

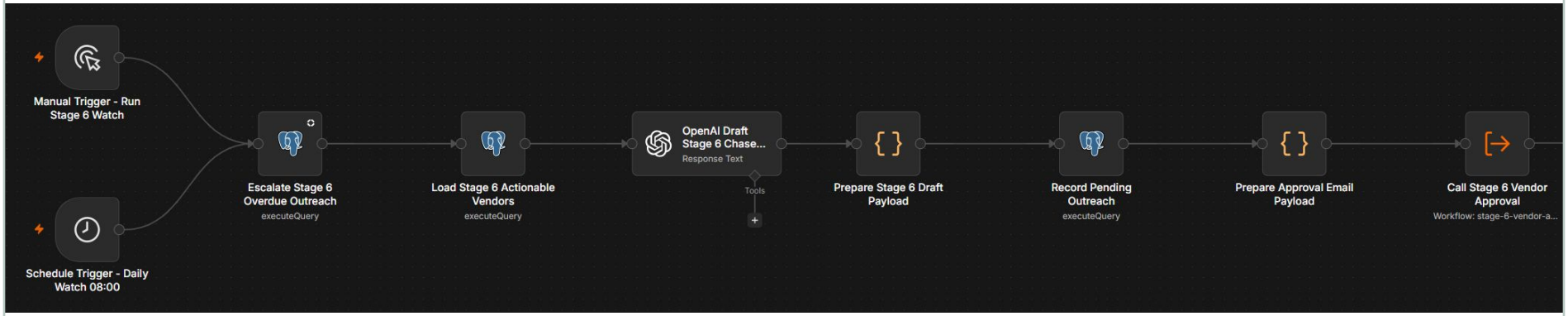
- Wrong holder or coverage below the minimum is flagged for review.
- A non-certificate attachment creates a notice without filing a certificate.
- Renewal history can supersede an older record and surface a coverage gap.

Repeatable decisions

Structured extraction supplies the facts; fixed validation rules apply the same holder, date and coverage checks to each incoming document.

Find due vendors and prepare the follow-up

A scheduled or manual run reads the vendor register, applies chase rules, and prepares one approval request for each actionable vendor.



From register state to a pending request

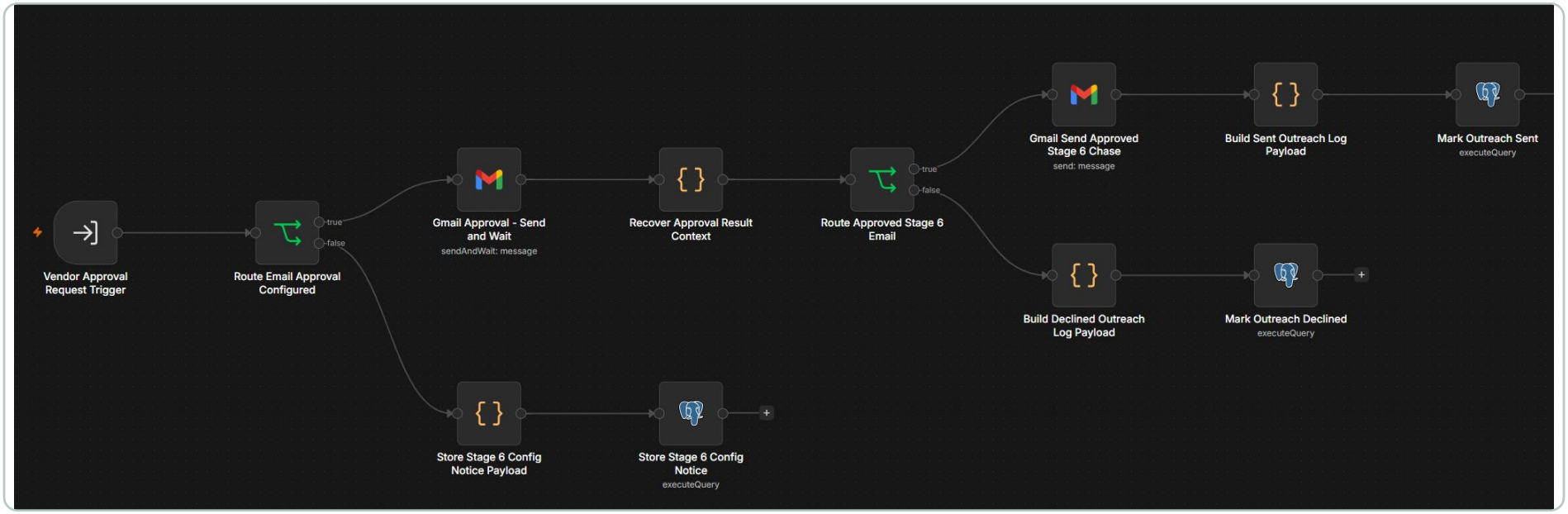
- Postgres selects vendors due for a first request, renewal follow-up, or escalation.
- The workflow drafts an email, records pending outreach, and prepares the approval payload.
- It calls Vendor Approval Request once per vendor, giving each decision its own execution.

What the workflow produces

A recorded follow-up awaiting a human send decision for each actionable vendor.

One decision for each vendor

Each prepared message enters its own workflow execution, so an approver can review and decide on that vendor's message independently.



From approval to a recorded outcome

- Checks the approval configuration, then sends the draft to the human approver.
- An approved decision sends the message; a declined decision stops that send.
- Both paths write the outcome to the outreach log in Postgres.

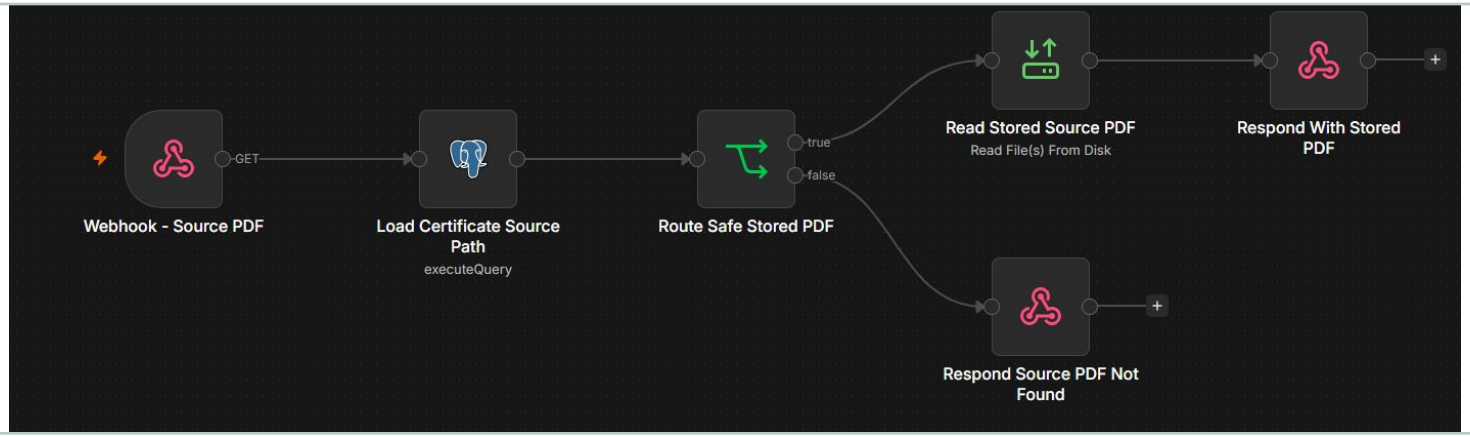
Why each vendor runs separately

A separate execution gives every approval request its own pause and response, including when several vendors are due together.

Source access and reply capture

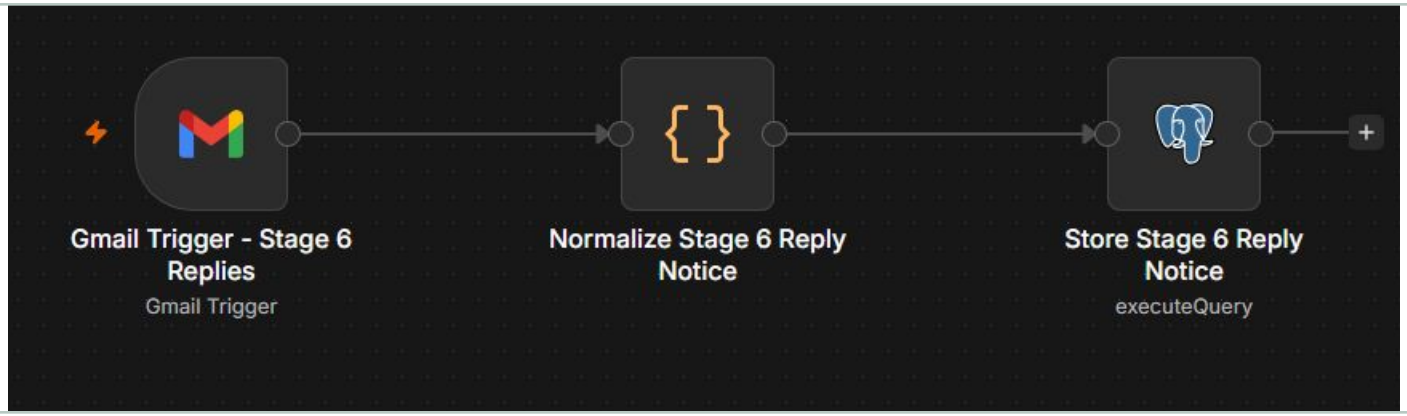
Small workflows handle two practical edge cases without making the intake canvas harder to follow.

SOURCE DOCUMENT ROUTE / 6 functional nodes



A dashboard link looks up the certificate's stored file and returns the original PDF or a not-found response.

NON-PDF REPLY NOTICE / 3 functional nodes



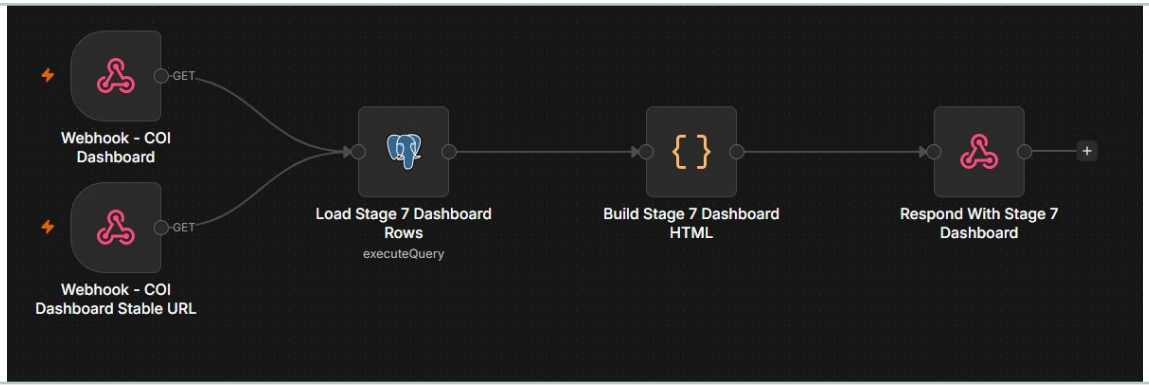
Replies without a PDF become notices for a manager; portal links are not fetched automatically.

WORKFLOW 06 / COI DASHBOARD

A register backed by workflow state

The webhook reads the Postgres view and renders an HTML board with vendor status, review flags and source-document links.

DASHBOARD WORKFLOW / 5 functional nodes



RENDERED REGISTER / illustrative synthetic rows

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Vendor Insurance Register

Auto-refreshes every 5 seconds

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The source-document links were exercised through the running dashboard.

VERIFICATION

Tested with synthetic scenarios

The local verification suite passed its certificate, workflow and dashboard checks using synthetic test data.

Intake	Valid, expired, scanned, password-protected and non-certificate PDFs
Validation	Wrong holder, low limits, missing GL, inverted dates and duplicate vendor
History	Two attachments, renewal supersession and a 14-day coverage gap
Dashboard	18 seeded vendors, source links, gap count and status views
Approval	Separate per-vendor waits, sends and decline logging verified in a later live test

End-to-end proof

The fixture run exercised document intake, stored source PDFs, validation outcomes and the rendered vendor register. A separate two-vendor live test confirmed independent approval waits and sends.

All examples shown in this sample use synthetic vendors and certificates.